

grain GAIN

✱ **Madan Lal Kumawat, 41**
Project An improvised time saving thresher with attachments which adapts to different grains

Aspiration To come up with as many inventions as possible

India's total foodgrain production for 2007-08 was 227.32 million tonne compared to 213.2 million tonne in 2003-04



PURUSHOTTAM DIWAK

The village of Danta Ramgarh is famous for two reasons. One right, the other wrong. It's the place that inspired former vice-president Bhairon Singh Shekhawat to take the political plunge. And it's not the mythical Ramgarh of India's most famous action film, *Sholay*. This curious backdrop is home to Shankar Madan Lal Krishi Shankar Udyog, 41-

year-old Madan Lal Kumawat's grain-threshing workshop. Kumawat, a mechanic, was working with Kailash Krishi Yantra Udyog, in Bagru, a town near Jaipur, on machines which were brought from Punjab. After selling about 10 thrashers, the farmers asked for repairs so that the machines would suit their needs. But even after repairs, they were not satisfied. This is when he and his employer decided to build one and kept improving it to solve the problem of damaged grain. In 1997, he set up his own workshop in Bagru, at a cost of Rs 3.5 lakh provided by his landlords. Here he tackled another problem: the threshers available in Punjab were not multi-grain friendly. It took two-and-a-half hours to change the fitting according to the type of grain. Now he has refined the process by adding six meshes of different

sizes that can easily be pulled out and replaced within 10 minutes. He reduced the diameter of the rotating drum, which reduced diesel consumption by a litre for every hour it ran. An air circulation system with a fan helped separate the grain from the husk. When farmers complained that they had to climb on top of the thresher to feed the grain, he brought the mouth to a lower level.

Kumawat's thresher processes wheat, cumin seeds, mustard, millet, maize, gram and moong. He is still improvising it to process groundnut better as farmers want it to be lightweight and not wasted as much.

At Rs 1.85 lakh a piece, he sells over a dozen machines every season and makes a profit of Rs 18,000 on each. His model has been cloned, but he has not stopped at that. He is now working on a handpump which gives users sufficient time to pump water and drink from the outlet. He has sold more than 50 of these. With Kumawat's efforts, Danta Ramgarh may well become more popular than *Sholay*'s Ramgarh. **by Rohit Par**

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If you listen to the customers' demand, you can make positive changes in your products.

MADAN LAL KUMAWAT, Manufacturer

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